

THE DUTCH BROS STORY

TWO BROTHERS, ONE PUSHCART, A BILLION-DOLLAR IPO

From a \$12,000 espresso pushcart to a public company on the New York Stock Exchange. Sources: Wikipedia, Bloomberg, Forbes, The Oregonian, Oregon Encyclopedia.

In 1992, two brothers who had just lost their family dairy farm business pooled their savings for a single espresso pushcart in a small Oregon town. Nearly three decades later, that pushcart had become Dutch Bros -- over a thousand stores, a listing on the New York Stock Exchange, and a valuation in the billions. This is the story of how it happened.

THE START

Grants Pass, Oregon. 1992.

Fact	Detail
Founded	February 12, 1992, in Grants Pass, Oregon.
Founders	Brothers Dane and Travis Boersma -- Dane was 38, Travis was 21. Third-generation dairy farmers.
The backstory	Their family's dairy farm was struggling due to changing industry regulations. They needed a new path.
Starting capital	Roughly \$12,000 pooled from their own savings to buy a double-head espresso machine and a pushcart.
The first move	Experimented with coffee flavors in their old milk house, handed out free samples to friends and family, then took the pushcart to the railroad tracks in downtown Grants Pass.
The name	Named "Dutch Bros" in honor of their Dutch-immigrant grandparents.

Two brothers, no coffee background, \$12,000, and a pushcart by the railroad tracks. That is the entire starting point.

THE GROWTH

From one cart to a national culture

Milestone	Detail
Early expansion	Within a short time, the brothers had grown from one pushcart to five.
First drive-thru	1994 -- opened their first drive-through location, setting the format the brand is now known for.
Franchising begins	2000 -- opened their first franchise location, expanding beyond Grants Pass into neighbouring towns and states.
The culture	Baristas are called "broistas." The company built its identity on speed, positivity, and community -- described by co-founder Travis Boersma as "the relationship business, and love is the product."
A tribute that stuck	Dane Boersma passed away in 2009. Every year since, Dutch Bros holds "Drink One for Dane," donating proceeds from that day across all locations to ALS research and support.

2017	Over 283 locations. The company stopped offering new franchises and shifted to opening only company-owned stores.
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THE SCALE

From a small Oregon town
to Wall Street

Milestone	Detail
IPO	September 15, 2021 -- listed on the New York Stock Exchange under the ticker BROS. Priced at \$23 a share, shares jumped more than 50% on debut day.
IPO valuation	Roughly \$3.3-3.8 billion -- the largest IPO in Oregon's history at the time.
Locations today	Over 1,000 stores across the US per Wikipedia (2025), grown from a single pushcart in one town.
2024 revenue	\$1.17 billion, per company filings.
2024 net income	\$35.3 million.
Employees	Approximately 17,000 as of 2024.
Market value today	Reported in the \$6-8 billion range as of early 2026.

The Takeaway

No coffee background. No outside investors at the start. Just two brothers, \$12,000, and a pushcart by a railroad track in a town of 37,000 people. Coffee was never a scarce idea -- it was already everywhere. What Dutch Bros built was a feeling nobody else was selling: speed, energy, and genuine warmth at a drive-thru window. Three decades later, that feeling is worth billions of dollars, one cup at a time.